

## 5 WORDPRESS PLUGINS

WordPress Plugins are composed of PHP scripts that add additional functionality to your blog. They offer new additions to your blog that either enhance features that were already available or add otherwise unavailable new features to your site.

Plugins extend the functionality of WordPress. The majority of WordPress users don't require Plugins, or only require a few, such as Plugins dealing with comment spam or customised post listings. Other users enjoy the varied options Plugins provide such as frequently updated weather reports, post word counts, rating systems, and more. Since the choice in Plugins is vast, and chosen based upon the needs of the user, they are not incorporated into the core of WordPress.

### 5.1 Installing Plugins

WordPress offers simple and easy ways of adding Plugins to your blog. From the Administration Panels, click on the Plugin tab. Once you have uploaded a plugin to your WordPress plugin directory, activate it from the Plugins Management page, and sit back and watch your plugin work.

There are two ways to do that:

- WordPress built-in installer – search, install and activate completely in the Add New menu.
- Traditional manual installation - get and expand zip files, upload to your sever, and activate.

#### 5.1.1 Manual Plugin Installation

To install a plugin that is not in the plugin browser, you should follow the given steps. Don't forget to backup just in case.

1. Upload the plugin to the wp-content/plugins folder in your WordPress directory online.
2. Make any changes to templates or files as required by the Plugin instructions including adding Plugin template tags.
3. Activate the Plugin:
  - a. Access the Plugin Panel in your Administration Panels
  - b. Scroll down through the list of Plugins to find the newly installed Plugin (if not visible, start from the beginning to check to see if you followed the instructions properly and uploaded the file correctly).